

The Shepherd

Avril Coleridge-Taylor

The Shepherd

William Blake (1757 – 1827)
from *Song of Innocence* (1789)

Avril Coleridge-Taylor (1903 – 1998)
arr. Zoë Birtwhistle for The Sheffield Chorale (Christmas 2025)

Expressivo **poco rit.** **a tempo**

Soprano

Alto

Tenor

Bass

How sweet is the Shep - herd's sweet

How sweet is the Shep - herd's sweet

p

p

Expressivo poco rit. a tempo

p

sempre sostenuto e legato

5

p

From morn to the

From the morn to the eve - ning he strays;

lot: to the eve - ning he strays;

lot: From the morn to the eve - ning he

p

9

mp

eve - ning he strays; He shall

mp

He shall fol - low his

mp

He shall fol - low his

mp

strays; He shall

13

mf

fol - low his sheep all the day, And his

mf

sheep, He shall fol - low his sheep all the day, And his

mf

sheep all the day, And his

mf

fol - low his sheep all the day, all the day, And his

17 *f*

And his tongue — shall be filled with praise.

f

— And his tongue — filled with praise. —

f

tongue shall be filled — with — praise. —

f

tongue shall be filled with praise.

21 **rit.** **a tempo** *pp*

For he

pp

For he

pp

For he

p **a tempo**

25

hears the lambs' in - no - cent call

hears the lambs' in - no - cent call

hears the lambs' in - no - cent call

hears the lambs' call And he hears the

pp *mp*

8va

29

And he hears the ewes' ten - der re -

And he hears the ewes' ten - der re -

And he hears the ewes' ten - der re -

ewes' ten - der re - ply; He is watch - ful while

p *p* *mp* *p*

loco

(8)

33

- ply; For they know when their

they are in peace For they know when their Shep - herd is

For they know when their Shep - herd is nigh,

they are in peace For they know when their

crescc.

37 *mp* Shep - herd is *pp* nigh, *p* when their Shep - herd is

Shep - herd is nigh, *p* For they know when their Shep - herd is

nigh, For they know when their Shep - herd is

For they know when their Shep - herd is

Shep - herd is nigh, their Shep - herd is

8va *loco* *dim.*

41 *> pp* , Lento rit. ,

The musical score consists of five staves. The first four staves are vocal parts, each starting with a piano (*pp*) dynamic and a 'nigh.' vocalization. The fifth staff is the piano accompaniment, which begins in measure 41 with a piano (*pp*) dynamic. The tempo is marked 'Lento' and 'rit.' (ritardando). The key signature has two sharps (F# and C#). The time signature is 8/8. The score is divided into measures 41, 42, 43, and 44. Measures 41-43 show vocal staves with 'nigh.' and piano accompaniment. Measure 44 shows a full piano accompaniment with 'Lento' and 'rit.' markings.

nigh. nigh. nigh. nigh.

pp *pp* *pp* *pp*

Lento rit.

pp *pp* *ppp*